

POCHOIR by PAINTERS

**An Exhibition of Books, Folios, Prints, and Ephemera,
1918–1938,
from the Collection of Charles Rahn Fry**



December 6, 1988–March 3, 1989

**Thomas J. Watson Library
The Metropolitan Museum of Art**

Preface

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Cover: Gino Severini: "Les Prouesses d'Arlequin," from *Fleurs et Masques*, 1930 (cat. no. 15).

Preface

This small exhibition of books, folios, prints, and ephemera brings together some of the pochoir, or stencil, works created between 1918 and 1938 mostly by painters living in France. There are twenty-eight artists represented in various formats: prints, book illustrations, costume and stage designs, and maquettes for *tapis* (carpets), a popular decorative art form of the period. (Picasso, Arp, Gontcharova, and Léger are just a few of the artists who made designs for *tapis*.)

Different uses of stencil are illustrated in these diverse works. There is, for example, a series of small invitations to openings at Léonce Rosenberg's Galerie L'Effort Moderne (cat. no. 1), which reproduces compositions, some of them rather crudely colored, by Gris, Herbin, Csaky, Léger, Metzinger, Surville, and Valmier. By contrast, the ten large-scale compositions of Man Ray's *Revolving Doors* (cat. no. 11), some with translucent overlays, are magnificently achieved. And the blend of text and illustration in Fernand Léger's images for Blaise Cendrars's *La Fin du monde filmée par l'ange N.-D* (cat. no. 3) is one of the most daring examples of period book design. Watercolors on Arches paper by the sculptor Antoine Bourdelle for *La Reine de Saba* (cat. no. 5) are tours de force of pochoir illustration, remarkable for the direct expressive use of color, while Gino Severini's Neoclassical *Fleurs et Masques* (cat. no. 15) is uniquely elegant with the addition of gold and silver.

Even at the time of its widest use in France, in the 1920s, pochoir was not regarded by the bibliophilic establishment as a reproductive process of the first rank, an honor reserved for wood engraving, etching, and lithography, all of which could be used for color and black-and-white illustration. Pochoir was used by scores of artists, however, including the two leading decorative illustrators of the time, George Barbier, whose output in the medium was prolific, and François-Louis Schmied, who illustrated two books in pochoir, a four-volume *Odyssée* (1930–33) and *Lueurs et Pénombre* (1932).

The exceptional characteristics of pochoir are brilliance of color and vitality of texture similar to those of an original watercolor or gouache. In his Lyell Lectures on "The Art Deco Book," given at Oxford University in April 1985, Gordon Ray noted that Jean Sauté, whose pochoir studio in Paris was the most renowned of the time, favored the word *illuminated* when speaking

of pochoir-illustrated books. This term recalls medieval book illustration and the artisans who applied paints by hand to produce the rich, lasting colors and special texture for which they are celebrated. Saudé's book on pochoir, *Traité d'enluminure d'art au pochoir* (1925), is perhaps the most deluxe treatise published on any method of illustration in the twentieth century. Of the twenty-four works on display here, eight were produced by the Saudé studio. Other pochoir firms represented are those of Bergdoll, Beaufumé, Charpentier, Jacomet, Marty, and Richard. (Six works are anonymous, and one was produced jointly by Saudé and Beaufumé.)

Some painters felt a special affinity for pochoir. A case in point is Henri Matisse, whose *Jazz* (1947) is currently the most valuable twentieth-century illustrated book. Rejecting other processes, Matisse chose pochoir to illustrate *Jazz* years after this technique had been in decline as a result of the economic upheavals of the 1930s and '40s, the passing on of the master practitioners, the increased expense involved in its use, and the rise of photomechanical reproduction. Matisse's use of pochoir resulted in a masterpiece, demonstrating that this reproductive method could lead to color illustrations of the first order in the hands of a great artist who understood its capabilities. *Jazz* has taken its place alongside the *livres de peintres* of Rouault, Miró, Delaunay, and other twentieth-century masters.

While pochoir is used occasionally today, it is generally reserved for deluxe books or prints issued in very small quantities. One example is Frances Butler's *New Dryads*, "being a suite of pochoir-colored prints depicting Fashionable Dress observed in the Diurnal Realm," published by Poltroon Press (Berkeley, California, 1980) in an edition of fifteen copies. But the special appeal of pochoir is still to be found in the works of the first third of the century, when numerous studio workshops were engaged in pochoir and the output was substantial, diverse, and rich in charm.

I would like to thank Mindell Dubansky and William Walker for the invitation to organize this exhibition; Carl Little, for preparing the catalogue entries and editing this preface; Bill Hayward, who photographed the image on the cover; and Dale Roylance and Kimball Higgs for suggestions in mounting the exhibition. Unless otherwise credited, translations have been made by Carl Little.

Charles Rahn Fry

The Stencil Art of Pochoir

by Charles Rahn Fry

The pochoir process was used to produce portfolios, books, limited edition journals, decorative and fine art prints between 1895 and 1935 in France. The main subjects were fashion, architecture, and design in addition to book illustration. During this time frame the foremost artists and artisans collaborated in the production of these graphic masterworks, many of which are little known or understood today.

Pochoir was essentially a stencil method of color reproduction developed in France. Indeed, pochoir is the French word for stencil. Its purpose was to duplicate or multiply an original image. Simple in concept, the technique became complex in practice with as many as one hundred stencils used for a single print.

Creating the image was the province of the artist. Then the pochoir artisan took over. He analyzed the composition, determined and prepared the number of stencils needed, figured out the order of printing application, selected the paints, and put on the color.

In comparison to other reproduction techniques, pochoir was unique in another way. It was almost completely manual. The stroking, daubing, brushing, spraying, or spattering on of each color through each stencil cutout was done by hand. Pochoir devotees hailed this human aspect, believing the image to be truer since it was achieved by hand without contamination of mechanical printing devices. In addition the colors were purer since they were the same as those used in the original. The pochoir compositions had two other qualities that flat printing didn't provide: texture and a potential for variety, because they were all done by hand.

The use of stencils has been traced to Theodoric, the king of the Ostrogoths (454–A.D. 526), who was illiterate and used a stencil of gold ingot to trace his initials. Today, in a different context, stencils are used to mark delivery cartons by the millions. For years the appeal of stencils lay in the simplicity, cheapness, and speed with which they could be used by almost anyone. At the end of the nineteenth century, intricate Japanese stencils used for printing textiles were brought to France and seemed to spur the development of pochoir for fine books and prints.

The individual who most influenced pochoir was Jean Saudé. Works from the 1890s through the 1930s carry his name. In 1924, the year before the Paris International Exposition of Decorative and Modern Industrial Arts, Saudé prepared a treatise to explain, demonstrate, and celebrate pochoir, replete with examples of its variety. It is called *Traité d'enluminure d'art au pochoir*. This document is the basis for understanding pochoir today.

The Saudé studio was one of a number of important pochoir workshops. Others were Greningaire et Fils, Ranson et Fils, E. Charpentier, M. Beaufumé, and D. Jacomet. André Marty is said to be the pioneer at whose studio, Greningaire et Fils, Saudé was educated in pochoir. The artist Edouard Bénédictus, writing in the Saudé treatise, recalled that around the turn of the century pochoir was a lowly tool used for stenciling cut-out letters on cartons. Bénédictus says that, remarkably, Saudé had a vision of the wide range of pochoir; he believed that the technique could serve as a link between the artist and the public and proclaimed that pochoir, through its dependence on manual application in the reproduction process, made possible true art instead of altered reproductions. Saudé believed that pochoir was the only process that translated the artist's original intent from the first to the last print, because it was entirely done by hand.

There are a number of characteristics visible in pochoir prints that are not similarly obtainable by other reproduction methods.

1. If a thick paint medium is used there is a buildup against the stencil edge where the paint runs into it, often resulting in a defined surface elevation. This can be both seen and felt.
2. If the brush is moved straight across a stencil, the traces of the bristle are evident.
3. Varying the pressure on the brush can result in a shading or gradation effect.
4. Textural variety can be accomplished by daubing, spraying, spattering, or sponging.
5. Transparent watercolor can be imposed on top of thick, opaque gouache, resulting in a unique contrast.

Some pochoirs were made up only of different flat-color areas. In most, however, an outline was first printed mechanically to provide a linear focus for the image and to assist in the placement of stencils. Black tones were

sometimes mechanically printed to give dimensional depth to the colors stenciled over. At the same time, the title, name of the artist, or plate number might be printed. In many architectural images a photograph was mechanically printed first, with color stenciled over. Color could also be pochoired onto engravings, lithographs, and etchings, and combined with other processes. Pochoir complemented the enthusiasm for color shown by artists of the period. No tone was too startling, no effect too brilliant, no contrast too striking for presentation by pochoir.

The technical aspects of the pochoir process are clearly defined and easily understood. First, the artist created the image to be reproduced in watercolor or gouache. The colors in the image were then analyzed and recomposed. Colors were divided between impastes and chemicals. Impastes were thicker and more solid and numbered about fifty colors. "Chemicals" were preferred because of their transparency and extraordinary range. More than 1,400 were available. The number of necessary stencils was determined, and the material from which to cut them was decided on. Copper, zinc, oiled cardboard, and celluloid were possible choices. The number of stencils depended on the number of colors in the image, plus extra stencils for colors requiring more than one application because of the composition of the image. Stencil thickness varied from 1/10 to 6/100 of a centimeter, depending on the detail of the cutouts and the quality of the reproduction. Zinc stencils were generally suitable. Copper stencils were reserved for elaborate cutouts and large printings. Stencils for gouaches or metallic paints were cut thinner than stencils for watercolors. Fields of the same color in a particular image were traced onto a paper sheet, which was placed over the material from which the stencil was to be cut and then made fast. The cutting of a metal stencil was then done with a small steel blade as pointed as a stiletto. The blade was fastened to a wooden handle, held like a pencil, and used by thrusting with small strokes, then pulling toward one. The cutting was done on a surface covered with linoleum. When cut out, the stencil was straightened by putting it through a rolling press between sheets of zinc and cardboard. Trial runs were made to test the accuracy of the stencils and to verify the correctness of the colors. Generally, strong colors were put down first, with the light ones overlapping them by a fraction of a centimeter.

The standard tools for applying the colors were brushes, pompons, and gudgeons. They were usually made of hog bristles in varying shapes and sizes, depending on whether paint was to be applied flat or shaded.

The sheets of paper receiving the color were passed along in assembly-line fashion until all the colors had been laid down. Each color had to dry before the next one was applied.

Finished pochoirs were examined and approved before release to the commercial marketplace as true multi-originals of the artist's creation.

The use of pochoir waned in the 1930s. The depression that swept the world lessened the market for expensive works in pochoir. Jean Saudé, the inspired leader, grew old and a new generation embraced other printmaking processes.

Catalogue

by Carl Little

1.

Exhibition announcements

Group of eight invitation-announcements (each measuring approximately 4 $\frac{7}{8}$ by 6 $\frac{1}{3}$ inches) to exhibitions at the Galerie L'Effort Moderne, run by Léonce Rosenberg and located 19, rue de la Baume, Paris. The exhibitions date from March 1, 1918, to March 31, 1921.

The cards graphically incorporate in color pochoir the Cubist-style compositions of Auguste Herbin (two), Joseph Csaky, Juan Gris, Fernand Léger, A. (Jean) Metzinger, Léopold Survage, and Georges Valmier. Several of the pochoir compositions appear to be original, in other words, created specifically for the exhibition announcements.

2.

Fernand Léger and Blaise Cendrars:

La Fin du monde filmée par l'ange N.-D.

Paris, Éditions de la Sirène, 1919. First edition, issued in 1,225 copies; number 214 of 1,200 numbered copies printed by Frazier-Soye, Paris, on vélin Lafuma paper. Quarto; unpaginated (30 pages); original pictorial wrappers.

This novel by Blaise Cendrars is illustrated with a frontispiece vignette and eighteen color plates (ten full-page, three double-spread, and five half-page images) by Fernand Léger. The illustrations were colored in pochoir by the Richard studios, Paris. The covers reproduce black-and-white compositions by Léger. This is a landmark in modern book illustration, in which the Cubist images and the text are treated as a unity; in several cases, the text has been printed over an illustration. Léger's compositions incorporate images of jazz, vaudeville, and so on, and make use of large, stenciled letters in a very dynamic manner.

The text takes the form of a film script, the final lines being "and one sees, as at the beginning, God the Father seated at his American desk, chewing furiously on his cigars. Etc. This is bankruptcy."

3.

Raoul Dufy and Stéphane Mallarmé: *Madrigaux*

Paris, Éditions de la Sirène, 1920. Limited edition, issued in 1,110 copies; number 646 of 1,000 numbered copies printed by Louis Kaldor on vélin Lafuma de Voiron paper. Quarto; unpaginated (32 pages); original printed blue wrappers with publisher's device (a siren); uncut.

These poems by Mallarmé are illustrated with twenty-five full-page color plates by Raoul Dufy, printed by the Aimé Jourde press and colored in pochoir by the Richard studios. The plates include depictions of a croquet game, flower arrangements, sailors, Verlaine reading in a bed at the Hôpital Broussais, a young Monet painting *en plein air* at Giverny, Easter eggs, and a stunning hat that incorporates a bird.

According to the publisher's note, these "madrigals, whims, and addresses" (the longest is five lines) were selected from a group of *petits vers* by Mallarmé and were published here for the first time.

4.

André Lhote and Jean Cocteau: *Escales*

Paris, Éditions de la Sirène, 1920. Limited edition, issued in 440 copies; number 314 of 400 numbered copies printed on vélin pur fil Lafuma paper. Quarto; unpaginated (72 pages); original pictorial wrappers; uncut.

The text by Jean Cocteau is illustrated with ten color plates (nine full-page and one double-spread

images) and drawings by André Lhote. The plates were printed by Louis Kaldor and colored in pochoir by the Marty studios. The cover reproduces in color a composition by Lhote not included in the text. The small emblematic frontispiece in color showing a ship and a mermaid refers to the title of the work, *Escale*, ports of call.

The text by Cocteau consists of imagistic impressions of ports in various parts of the world and the sailors, prostitutes, dock hands, and so on, who frequent them. The layout of the type is quite unusual; at times it turns and twists with the fragmentary text or is printed at odd angles, recalling Apollinaire's *Calligrammes*.

5.

Émile-Antoine Bourdelle: *La Reine de Saba*

Paris, Société Littéraire de France, 1922. Limited edition, issued in 300 copies; number 198 of 260 numbered copies printed by Durand, Chartres, on vélin d'Arches paper. Quarto; 116 pages loose in sheets; original printed wrappers with printer's device; uncut; original slipcase, decorated with a repeated (stenciled?) motif of a cluster of six gold dots.

The legend of the Queen of Saba, a mythically beautiful woman called Balkis, translated by Dr. J.-C. Mardrus, is illustrated with fifty full-page watercolors, *hors texte*, by Émile-Antoine Bourdelle, colored in pochoir by Jean Saudé under the direction of the artist. These include a view of the city of Saba (in Yemen) perched atop precipitous mountains, genies, men on camels, Egyptian subjects, galley ships at sea, the "harpe séraphique," King Solomon, and angels. Many of the plates incorporate a handwritten line or an image from the text.

6.

Les Facheux

Paris, Éditions des Quatres Chemins, 1924, two volumes. Limited edition, issued in 500 copies; number 79 of 385 numbered copies printed by Frazier-Soye, Paris, on vélin d'Arches paper. Quarto; 38 pages (volume I); 14 pages (volume II); half levant green morocco with gilt fillers; center panels of patterned rice paper on upper and lower

covers; gilt backs with onlaid brown morocco, gilt tops; original pictorial wrappers; backstrips bound in (by G. Schroeder); uncut. Gilt initials M.D. on both spines.

Volume I is illustrated with a full-page portrait of Georges Auric by Jean Cocteau, a facsimile of a page of Auric's score for this one-act ballet by Boris Kochno, and twenty-three full-page compositions in color by Georges Braque, the latter executed in pochoir by the Daniel Jacomet studios, Paris. The drawings include a sketch and maquette for the set and numerous costume designs (front and back views given for four of them). The wrapper design for both volumes is a color composition by Braque, which incorporates a lute, a guitar, and the title of the ballet. The text consists of a recollection of the ballet by Cocteau and an article by the critic Louis Laloy.

Volume II has as a frontispiece a photographic portrait of Braque by Man Ray [sic] and twenty-two full-page black-and-white photographs of the performers by Georges Detaille (printed at the Numa Blanc studios, Monte Carlo).

This Kochno ballet, after a comedy-ballet by Molière, was first performed at Serge de Diaghilev's Théâtre de Monte-Carlo on January 19, 1924. It was choreographed by Madame Nijinska and included among its dancers Lubov Tchernicheva (as Orphise), Krassovska (as the Naiade), La Nijinska (as Lysandre), and Serge Lifar as one of the policemen.

7.

Georges Rouault and Henry Church: *Les Clowns*

Paris, Éditions des Deux Amis, 1922. Limited edition, issued in 250 copies; number 140 of 240 numbered copies printed by Frédéric Paillart, Abbeville, on vélin d'Arches paper. Octavo, 40 pages, original pictorial wrappers, uncut.

Illustrated with three drawings by Rouault reproduced in phototypography and colored in pochoir by Daniel Jacomet. Each plate depicts a single clown standing or kneeling. The cover reproduces in color the first plate in the text (opposite page 14).

The text, dated May 1913, concerns an evening spent at the "Mutton Chop Club" in New York City. There the narrator is told a rather tall tale by the "Colonel," a member of the club. As the story goes, the Colonel, on a trip with his friend Jack Hurdler to Kentucky's Blue Mountains, witnesses a meeting of the Ku Klux Klan on a desolate mountainside. Noting the somewhat acrobatic rituals and wild costumes of the men, Jack likens them to clowns.

8.

Paul Morand: *Ouvert la nuit* and *Fermé la nuit*

Paris, Éditions NRF (Nouvelle Revue Française), 1924 and 1925, respectively. The first book was issued in a limited edition of 320 copies; number 115 of 305 numbered copies printed on vélin pur Lafuma-Navarre paper. Quarto; 202 pages; original black and gold wrappers with stars; half-cloth slipcover; slipcase. The second book was issued in a limited edition of 407 copies; number 115 of 370 numbered copies printed on vélin pur fil Lafuma-Navarre paper. Quarto, red and black wrappers; uncut; half-cloth slipcover; slipcase.

Ouvert la nuit is illustrated with six full-page watercolors by Raoul Dufy, André Favory, Roger de la Fresnaye, André Lhote, Luc-Albert Moreau, and André Dunoyer de Segonzac. They are reproduced in pochoir by Jean Saudé.

Fermé la nuit is illustrated with five etchings in color (three full-page images, two double spreads) and thirty-six pen-and-ink drawings (many full-page images and double spreads) by Jules Pascin. The etchings were printed at the Roseraie studios, Paris.

According to the preface (dated September 1921), *Ouvert la nuit* recounts "quelques nuits avec des dames." *Fermé la nuit* contains further tales, the last of which, "La Nuit de Putney," includes several depictions of torture.

9.

Jules Pascin: *3 Petites Filles dan la rue*

Paris, Éditions de la Fanfare de Montparnasse, 1925. Second volume in "Fanfare de Montparnasse" series. Limited edition, issued in 710 copies; number 314 of 650 numbered copies printed by Coulouma, Argenteuil, on

vélin blanc paper. Quarto, 80 pages, original pink wrappers, uncut.

Illustrated with thirty-five drawings by Jules Pascin, comprising a full-page frontispiece, four double spreads, and thirty-four illustrations in the text. Colored in pochoir by Eugène Charpentier.

The text, by André Warnod, and illustrations consist of vignettes from the lives of three young women living in the Montparnasse quarter of Paris. According to the *Phaidon Encyclopedia of Art and Artists* (1978), Pascin "treated the female body as the image of the supreme recourse against the difficulties of life." A leading member of the School of Paris, Pascin committed suicide in 1930.

10.

Foujita: *Chansons des Geishas*

Paris, Aux Éditions G. Crès & Cie, 1926. Third volume in the series "Les heures légères." Limited edition, issued in 557 copies; number 91 of 470 numbered copies printed by Coulouma, Argenteuil, on vergé d'Arches paper. Tall octavo, 218 pages, original pictorial wrappers, uncut.

Illustrated with ten color plates *hors texte* (including the frontispiece) and approximately 145 vignettes (many repeated) by Foujita (Fujita Tsuguji, or Tsuguharu). The wrappers are decorated with a depiction of a geisha in color on the upper cover (not found in the book) and one of the vignettes, a Japanese lantern, also in color on the lower cover. The ten *hors texte* plates were colored in pochoir by Eugène Charpentier.

The color illustrations depict geishas in a variety of demure poses, several playing the *shamisen*, a three-string guitar; another smokes a long-stemmed pipe. The vignettes are of butterflies, birds, grasshoppers, cherry blossoms, fans, and other traditional elements of Japanese poetry and culture.

Likening these songs of the geishas to the music of Claude Debussy, the translators note in their introduction that "we are here in the presence of poetries or small tableaux or musical motifs of an *impressionist* nature and we cannot overburden them with explications without radically destroying their charm and naïveté."

11.

Man Ray: *Revolving Doors. 1916–1917*

Paris, Éditions Surréalistes, 1926. Limited edition; number 71 of 105 numbered copies signed by the artist. Folio, in sheets, title and list of plates on single small sheet laid in; ten plates; original black half-cloth portfolio with paper label on upper cover, ties. The colophon, printed on a single sheet, is mounted on the inside of the back cover.

This is an exquisite series of ten full-page color compositions by Man Ray executed in pochoir. The images consist of brightly colored, often interlocking, abstract and geometric forms set off with simple, printed black lines, circles, and shapes. The titles of the works—"Mime," "Orchestra," "Decanter," and on so—relate directly to the configurations of Man Ray's imagery.

12.

Joan Miró and Lise Hirtz: "*Il Était un petite pie*"

Paris, Éditions Jeanne Bucher, 1928. Limited edition, issued in 300 copies; number 267 of 280 numbered copies printed on Arches paper. Folio, nineteen sheets, original full-cloth folder with Miró design on front cover (reproducing illustration facing third song), ties, uncut, with two black cords holding sheets together.

The handwritten text, "7 chansons et 3 chansons pour Hyacinthe" by Lise Hirtz, is illustrated with eight gouaches by Joan Miró, reproduced in pochoir by Jean Saudé, "Maître Coloriste." A wonderful collaborative work, in which the playful nature of Hirtz's songs is perfectly matched by Miró's simple abstract illustrations.

13.

Georges Valmier: *Collection décors et couleurs. Album No 1*

Paris, Aux Éditions Albert Lévy, no date (c. 1930). Folio, in sheets, including title page printed in black and red and twenty plates; original half-cloth portfolio with circular title device in colors (pochoir) on upper cover; ties.

Superb collection of decorative designs by Valmier, reproduced in pochoir by Jean Saudé, with as many

as seven different images on a single plate rendered primarily in a patterned, Cubistic style. Valmier favored a "pure play of lines and curves" (Bénézit); in fact, several images in this folio recall Léger's work. Outstanding among those presented is the last, a study of a harlequin "à décomposition prismatique."

Valmier, a painter and lithographer, fell under the sway of Cubism around 1911. He first showed paintings and *papiers collés* in 1921. He designed masks for Marinetti's Futurist plays and was also known as an illustrator.

14.

Guillaume Janneau: *L'Art Cubiste. Théories et réalisations*

Paris, Éditions d'Art Charles Moreau, 1929. Limited edition; number 1588 of an unspecified number of copies printed by Ducros and Colas, Paris. Quarto; 118 pages; original pictorial wrappers with a Cubist composition on the upper cover; uncut; marbled paper slipcase with gilt morocco label on spine.

This important early critical study of Cubism is illustrated with forty-eight full-page plates reproducing paintings, collages, sculpture, drawings, and watercolors by Picasso, Braque, Léger, Gris, Gleizes, Herbin, Marcoussis, Valmier, Laurens, Lhote, Czaky, Severini, and Survage. Twelve plates have been executed in color pochoir by Daniel Jacomet. Among the subjects are the formation of the Cubist school, expressionist Cubism, and the "consequences and position of Cubism." The introductory chapter discusses the origins of Cubism and the first endeavors of artists in a Cubist style.

15.

Gino Severini: *Fleurs et Masques*

London, Frederick Etchells & Hugh MacDonald, 1930. Limited edition; number 84 of 125 numbered copies printed by the Pelican Press, London, on Lafuma paper. Folio; 27 pages, including title page, sixteen plates, colophon, list of plates, and printer's page; original vellum paper over boards, with author's name, title of work and printer's device on upper cover, gilt morocco label on spine (added later); beige cloth slipcase.

This extraordinary collection of sixteen full-color compositions by Severini was reproduced in pochoir by Jean Saudé. The subjects—harlequins, musicians, still lifes—are in Severini's Neoclassical style, although the "Prelude" plate and several others display a strongly Cubistic sensibility. Well-known as a founding member of the Italian Futurists, Severini in 1920 to 1921 "reverted to a Neo-classical, objective style. In his harlequin pictures, still lifes and interiors, the pictorial objects, which are fully modelled, are removed from a naturalistic to a metaphysical level of reality by the cool uniform light" (*Phaidon Dictionary of Twentieth Century Art*). Around 1930, the year of this folio, Severini began to cultivate a decorative form of Cubism, again following Picasso's lead.

16.

Dessins. 20 planches en couleurs

Paris, Librairie des Arts Décoratifs, no date (c. 1930). Folio, in sheets, including title page, list of artists, and twenty plates; original half-silver cloth portfolio with "Dessins" on upper cover in large silver letters against a red velvet-type material.

Splendid series of full-color decorative designs, executed in pochoir, each plate with two or more different patterns. Among the best known of the ten artists represented are Henry Valensi, whose designs reflect his Orientalist leanings as well as his interest in "Effusioniste" painting (he was also connected with the "Section d'Or" group that included Duchamp and Picabia); Jacques Camus, known for his decorative work (wallpaper, fabrics, rugs, and so on), and who won a silver medal at the 1925 Exposition Internationale des Arts Décoratifs; Marianne Clouzot, an illustrator and decorator; and Alexandra Bitchkova, Russian-born artist who designed embroidery as well as the curtains for several theaters in Russia (she exhibited in the 1929 and 1931 Salons des Indépendants). Other artists are Yvonne Bouchaud, Alexey Brodovitch, Serge Gladky, Boris Lacroix, Okolow, and Tchimoukow (whose designs are dated 1929). The addresses of the artists are provided.

The designs range in style from Jazz Age to Cubist, from geometric to abstract, from Russian

Constructivist to Art Deco. A. Calavas was in charge of the publication (his name appears in the lower right-hand corner of each plate).

17.

Tapis modernes

Paris, Mr. H. Ernst, Éditeur, no date (c. 1930). Limited edition; number 174 of an unspecified number of copies. Folio; three sheets and forty plates; original half-cloth folder with ties, upper cover design in pochoir consisting of the word TAPIS in large red letters set on the diagonal and an overall pattern of small green and white squares.

Unusual collection of around seventy-five rug designs, mounted on forty sheets of ruled brown paper, each bearing the artist's name as well as that of the rug's manufacturer (except in the case of maquettes). Among the artists represented are Picasso, Arp (given as Harpe), Marcoussis, Lurçat, Gontcharova, and Léger. Other artists known for their work in the decorative arts include Voldemar Bobermann, Jean Burkhalter, Jean and Jacques Adnet, Jean-François Laglenne, Edouard Bénédictus, and Georges de Feure.

The reproductions were executed in pochoir after watercolors. According to the introduction by M. Matet, who compiled the edition, "nearly all the reproductions were compared with the original rugs, then corrected or redone until acceptable." The designs are mainly Cubist in style and were executed after the 1925 Exposition des Arts Décoratifs, mentioned several times in the foreword. They are all examples of *point noué*, rugs woven with a knotted stitch, and they were made either in Paris or in North Africa.

18.

Marie Laurencin: Deuxième Album de Marie Laurencin

Paris, Quatre Chemins, no date (c. 1930). Limited edition; number 113 of 250 numbered copies. Folio; in sheets, including front and back flyleaves and six plates; original half-cloth folder with ties; paper label on upper cover (paper colophon inside upper cover); each plate bears the raised stamp of the publisher in lower right-hand corner.

The six plates, after paintings by Marie Laurencin in the collections of Paul Rosenberg, Joseph Hessel, and M. A. Flechtheim, were reproduced in pochoir at the Daniel Jacomet studios, Paris. Titled *Le double portrait*, *Le petit bateau*, *Composition*, *Les jeunes filles*, *Les deux femmes*, and *Tête de femme*, they date from 1927 to 1929. All measure approximately 10 by 13 inches.

These delicate, idyllic pictures of graceful young girls rendered in pale, pastel shades are typical of Laurencin's style. The artist was connected with the Cubists, and her work reveals some aesthetic traits of this group.

19.

Kees van Dongen and Paul Poiret: *Deauville*

Paris, Éditions M.-P. Trémois, 1931. Limited edition, issued in 315 copies (plus 100 separate suites of the plates); number 15 of 280 numbered copies printed by Coulouma, Argenteuil, on vélin d'Arches paper. Folio; nineteen sheets, uncut; original pictorial wrappers, original half-cloth folder with ties.

The text by Paul Poiret is illustrated with five drawings in color and five copperplate engraved watercolors, *hors texte*, by Kees van Dongen. The engravings were executed by Maccard at the Presses de la Tradition, Paris. The drawings were reproduced in pochoir by the Art Bergdoll studio.

The plates show a casino ("La Salle de Baccara"), restaurant (with stage show), a crowd at the Grand Prix de Normandie horse race, and two beach scenes. The drawings are abbreviated yet highly gestural figure studies. Van Dongen, of Dutch origin, became a member of the Fauves in 1906, "the most faithful and perhaps most gifted [artist] of the group" (*Phaidon Encyclopedia of Art and Artists*). Van Dongen's seascapes of Deauville are considered to be among his greatest achievements.

The text by Poiret, the well-known couturier and a friend to many of the artists of his time, consists of an introduction and five short poetic sketches of various milieus in Deauville, a popular resort on the Normandy coast.

20.

Léon Moussinac: *Tendances nouvelles du théâtre*

Paris, Éditions Albert Lévy, 1931. Limited edition, issued in 615 copies; number 418 of 600 numbered copies printed by Louis Kaldor, Paris. Large quarto, 42 pages; original gray wrappers with title and author's and publisher's names in red, white, and blue on upper cover; uncut; bound in full blue cloth.

This wide-ranging survey of the theater, covering the years 1915 to 1930, is illustrated with 124 plates on which are found the following: approximately 314 black-and-white illustrations (heliotypography by Faucheux, in Chelles) and 150 illustrations either partly or entirely in color (123 small, 27 larger), reproduced in pochoir by Jean Saudé. The black-and-white plates include sets, photographs of performances, and theater designs; the pochoir plates include Picasso's costumes and a maquette for the set of *Tricorne*, 1919; designs by Rodchenko; the "théâtre magnétique" of Prampolini, 1925; Jean Hugo's costumes for Cocteau's *Les Mariés de la Tour Eiffel*; Georges Valmier's watercolors; Léger's designs for Cendrars's *Ballet Nègre*; designs by Norman Bel Geddes and Lee Simonson; and L. F. Popova's extraordinary set construction for Crommelynck's *Le Cocu Magnifique*.

Moussinac provides an enlightening introduction (with bibliography), which comments on new trends in the theater throughout the world, including France, the United States of America, Russia, South America, Germany, Czechoslovakia, and Italy.

21.

Dix Reproductions 1933: Braque, Derain, Dufy, Gris, Léger, Lurçat, Masson, Matisse, Picasso, Rouault

Paris and New York, Éditions Jeanne Bucher and Éditions John Becker, 1933. Limited edition, issued in 1,000 copies. Printed in France on vélin d'Arches paper. Text printed by the Imprimerie Aulard. Folio; two sheets (title page, colophon, list of works) and ten plates, each measuring 15¾ by 20½ inches; original paper covers, printed paper label on upper cover; uncut. Each plate bears the stamped initials JB (Jeanne Bucher) in the lower

left-hand corner. A small paper label identifying the work is affixed to the verso of each plate.

This is a superb collection, beautifully reproduced, of exemplary works by these modern masters. Half the works were loaned by the artists themselves, the other half by various galleries and collectors. With the exception of the Dufy, Masson, Matisse, and Rouault, the works were all reproduced in the size of the originals. The Léger, Lurçat, and Picasso plates were reproduced in pochoir by the Jean Saudé studio; those of Braque, Derain, and Gris, also in pochoir, and those of Masson and Rouault, by the Beaufumé studio. The drawings by Dufy and Matisse were reproduced by the Faucheux and F. Duvall studios, respectively.

22.

André Derain and Oscar Wilde: *Salomé*

London and Paris, The Limited Editions Club, 1938, two volumes. Limited edition; number 238 of 1,500 copies. Volume I printed by the Fanfare Press, London, under the direction of Ernest Ingham; volume II was designed by René Ben Sussan and printed by Dehon et Cie, Paris, in a new typeface designed by A. M. Cassandre and set by hand. Quarto; 114 pages (volume I) and 80 pages (volume II): full pinkish-red cloth with gilt design of poppies(?) after Beardsley and gilt lettering on upper cover and spine, uncut (volume I); original printed black wrappers, uncut (volume II); original slipcase.

The first volume reproduces Lord Alfred Douglas's original translation of Oscar Wilde's one-act tragedy and the original illustrations by Aubrey Beardsley, which comprise fourteen full-page compositions and a design for the title page and for the list of pictures. The illustrations are among Beardsley's best known and exemplify the Art Nouveau style he cultivated so brilliantly. The second volume is illustrated with ten full-page gouache drawings on black paper, *hors texte*, by André Derain, reproduced in pochoir by Saudé. The colophon is signed by the artist. The compositions are suitably dramatic, emphasizing gesture. The way in which the faces are made up (rouged lips, black ink eyes and eyebrows) lends a theatrical, and sometimes humorous, touch to the characters. *Salomé* was written in 1891 and first

performed in 1896 at the Théâtre de l'Oeuvre in Paris, directed by Lugné-Poë.

23.

Sonia Delaunay: *Sonia Delaunay, ses peintures, ses objets, ses tissus simultanés, ses modes*

Paris, Librairie des Arts Décoratifs, no date (1925). Folio; in loose sheets, with eight pages of text and twenty plates; original red half-cloth portfolio with checkerboard design on upper cover in black, red, and gray on beige ground, with artist's name in black script across the middle cover in red.

Covering work from 1919 to 1925 (each plate is dated), this fine selection of Sonia Delaunay's work includes paintings, fashion and fabric designs, theater costumes, book bindings, and an exquisitely patterned jewelry box (plate 17), all in her signature Simultaneist style. The images are reproduced in color pochoir, with as many as five different designs on a plate. Each plate has stamped signature in the lower right-hand corner; they measure approximately 15 by 22 inches.

This homage to Delaunay was published in connection with the 1925 International Exhibition of Decorative Arts, for which Delaunay created a "Boutique Simultanée" with furrier Jacques Heim. Delaunay later wrote of this period in her work that, "for me there was no gap between my painting and my so-called decorative work . . . the minor art had never been an artistic frustration but a free expansion, a conquest of new spaces. It was the application of the same research" (Sonia Delaunay, *Nous irons jusqu'au soleil*, 1978, p. 96; translated in *Sonia Delaunay: A Retrospective*, Buffalo, 1980). In the same year of this collection Delaunay exhibited textiles at the Salon d'Automne and decorated the Citroën B 12 automobile.

Fellow artist André Lhote contributed a short introduction to this selection of work, interspersed with appreciations and reviews by Gleizes, Robert Delaunay, Cendrars, and Apollinaire. Lhote concludes that "it is necessary above all to thank [Delaunay] for having forced, in a most amicable way, the public, despite itself, to take interest in the most fertile pictorial manifestations of modern time." Poems by Joseph Delteil, Cendrars, Tristan Tzara, and Philippe Soupault round out this tribute.

24.

Sonia Delaunay: *Compositions, Couleurs, Idées*

Paris, Éditions d'Art Charles Moreau, no date (1930). Folio, in loose sheets, including four pages for title and half-title pages and forty plates; original pictorial half-cloth portfolio with Simultaneist composition in four colors by Delaunay on the upper cover, "Compositions" in gold lettering on spine; ties.

This remarkable collection consists of forty full-page color plates by Sonia Delaunay reproduced in pochoir. Delaunay was well-known for her textile designs; the "ideas" in this collection were probably

intended for decorative-arts projects. They display a range of styles, many of them experiments in the dynamic Simultaneist mode of which Delaunay was a major practitioner. Using brilliant colors, she creates abstract compositions, geometric patterns, and some representational motifs, such as the outstanding cloud forms on plate 9, a field of flowers (plate 18), and sailboats at sea (plate 25). The group perfectly represents the artist's wide-ranging imagination. Plate 25 is signed by the artist in pencil in the lower right-hand corner. Each plate measures approximately 12¾ by 9½ inches and is printed on a vellum-type stock.

